

GERALD TUIMALEALIIFANO

Contact

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Education

- Masters of IT
First Class Honors
University of Auckland, 2021
- Postgrad Cert in IT
University of Auckland, 2018
- Bachelor of CompSci
University of Auckland, 2013
- Cambridge International
Kings College, 2009

Tools

- AWS (EKS, EC2, RDS etc..)
- Terraform, Terragrunt
- Kubernetes, Docker, Helm
- Jenkins, FluxCD, Artifactory
- Python, Bash, Node.js
- React JS, HTML, CSS
- Microsoft Server Admin
- Linux Server Admin
- VMware Virtualization
- SQL, MySQL

Certs

- Certified Kubernetes
Administrator (CKA)
- AWS Solutions Architect
Associate
- Agile Scrum Master

References

- Available upon request



ABOUT ME

A highly experienced IT Leader and Strategist with a Masters in IT and over a decade in senior-level roles. My expertise encompasses strategic planning, project management, IT budgeting, software, systems and infrastructure support.

With a robust background in software, systems, and cloud engineering, I have assisted businesses in designing and implementing bespoke software, secure infrastructures, and scalable cloud solutions. I am dedicated to cultivating a culture of technical excellence by leading through example and sharing my enthusiasm for technology with my colleagues.



WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer (DevOps/SRE) at Workday

2023 - Present

Workday is a Fortune 500 company with over 20,000 employees, is a global leader in enterprise software and used by large-scale organizations for human capital management, accounting and business operations in a unified, AI-driven platform.

I provide strategic Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) and platform support for Workday's largest and most rapidly scaling Kubernetes platform, ensuring the resilience, security, and scalability of thousands of critical internal services used by Workday engineering.

• Key Achievements:

- **Enterprise Resilience & Architecture:** Engineered and managed the deployment of a highly available, multi-region EKS cluster on AWS, which achieved 99.99% uptime and reduced operational overhead by 50% through infrastructure optimization.
- **Digital Transformation & Efficiency:** Established Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) as a core tenet of platform deployment using Terraform/Terragrunt, drastically reducing infrastructure deployment time (from hours to minutes) and increasing engineering velocity.
- **Delivery Strategy & Process Governance:** Architected and delivered robust, production-grade CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins) that accelerated service delivery by 60% and improved overall team velocity by 50%.
- **Project & Team Leadership:** Served as Scrum Master and Technical Product Owner, responsible for leading strategic sprint planning, prioritizing team deliverables, and managing project execution.
- **Capacity Development & Advocacy:** Acted as a Technical Evangelist, delivering keynote presentations and training on Kubernetes and AWS to promote platform adoption and enhance internal team technical capacity.

Software Engineer (Full-Stack) at Workday

2021 - 2023

Developed and maintained a critical, end-to-end platform enabling tenant lifecycle management for Workday customers, focusing on large-scale automation, service reliability, and streamlining operational configuration processes.

• Key Achievements:

- **Quality & Reliability Strategy:** Implemented a new automation framework (Python, Cucumber/Gherkin) for API testing, achieving a 70% reduction in regression testing time and establishing a higher quality standard for platform releases.
- **Customer-Centric Service Delivery:** Modernized the platform's user interface (PrimeReact) to enhance usability and service consumption, resulting in a major usability upgrade for over 100 customers.
- **DevOps & Process Automation:** Streamlined the entire end-to-end release workflow by leveraging CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins and Kubernetes), demonstrating proficiency in automating enterprise-wide service delivery.
- **Code Governance & Workflow:** Established and maintained best practices for code collaboration, security, and version control using enterprise-level tools (GitHub, Bitbucket).

IT Manager at Kiwiplan

2019 – 2021

Kiwiplan, with over 200 employees, stands as a global frontrunner in ERP and MES software, focusing on automated production scheduling and supply chain solutions for the global corrugated and packaging sectors.

I provided strategic guidance to the ICT team, acting as the primary technical liaison. My role involved effectively communicating team capabilities and aligning IT initiatives with the priorities of business stakeholders, ensuring that our infrastructure enhanced organizational performance.

- **Key Achievements:**

- **Budget & Resource Management:** I took ownership of the annual IT budget and procurement processes, ensuring strategic allocation of resources for new hardware, operational services, and improvements to enterprise security infrastructure.
- **Strategic Team Leadership:** I led a team of five engineers, successfully delivering projects that boosted business performance. This involved mentoring and professionally developing IT engineers through industry certifications and training programs.
- **Policy Development and Execution:** I helped develop and successfully deliver a comprehensive five-year IT Business Policy that addressed Performance, Security, Disaster Recovery, Usage, and Infrastructure Scalability.
- **Negotiation and Stakeholder Engagement:** I maintained constant communication with global C-suite management and clients to negotiate contracts and secure buy-in for technical proposals.
- **Business Continuity & Resilience:** Within 24 hours, I implemented Kiwiplan's critical business continuity plan, enabling over 200 employees to transition to full remote operations during the COVID-19 pandemic. This demonstrated my ability to lead, collaborate, and communicate effectively across the entire organization.

Junior → Senior → Lead Systems Engineer at Kiwiplan

2014 – 2019

Managed and supported Kiwiplan's essential IT infrastructure and daily operations, advancing from Junior Engineer to Lead Engineer. My responsibilities encompassed infrastructure maintenance, process automation, data center modernization, and taking on a strategic leadership role to oversee budgets and client relationships.

- **Key Achievements:**

- **Leadership & Governance:** Implemented IT Business Policy, maintained primary customer relationships, and co-developed Service Level Agreements (SLAs) with stakeholders, which included traveling internationally to business offices and client sites.
- **Modernization & Cloud Migration:** Successfully directed the complete migration of the business from on-premises MS Exchange to MS 365, while modernizing data center infrastructure utilizing Dell and Cisco hardware.
- **Automation & Efficiency:** Streamlined critical processes through automation with Group Policy, Bash, and PowerShell, significantly reducing manual effort and enhancing operational efficiency.
- **Operational Excellence:** Led process enhancements by launching the first IT Helpdesk platform (Freshservice), centralizing 100% of support requests within 60 days, and providing expert support across a diverse infrastructure stack (VMWare, Cisco Networking, Linux, MS Active Directory, and security tools such as Checkpoint firewall).

+ EXTRA-CURRICULAR



Trustee and Tutor at Pasifika Tech Education Charity

2022 – Present

- **Leadership:** Appointed as a Trustee to contribute to the strategic direction of the charity. Submitting proposals for funding, acquiring sponsorships, forming business partnerships and charity promotion.
- **Community Impact:** Organized and hosted numerous Tech Career Days for highschool and university students at Workday NZ office. The students spend a day with real tech professionals sharing career journeys and pathways into tech giving students the opportunity to ask questions and gain real insights.
- **Technical Education & Advocacy:** Co-develop and deliver lessons in Software Development, Cybersecurity, Infrastructure and Computer Networking to high school students, utilising culturally grounded teaching methods to build confidence and curiosity in the digital world.



AWARDS & PRIZES



- **Masters of Information Technology with First Class Honors – 8.9/9.0 GPA**
- **Post Graduate in Information Technology – 9.0/9.0 GPA**
- **First in Course Awards:**
 - COMPSCI 718 – Software Programming for Industry (2018)
 - INFOSYS 735 – AWS Cloud Architecture (2019)
 - GLM711 – Strategic Entrepreneurship and Innovation (2020)
 - INFOSYS730 – Telecommunication Management (2020)
 - OPSMGT757 – Project Management (2021)
- **Scholarships:**
 - Toloa Tertiary Scholarship for Masters of IT funded by Ministry for Pacific Peoples (2020)
 - Kiwiplan Funding for Postgraduate in IT (2018–2020)
- **Workday Global Community Impact Award (2024)**
 - Recognition for leadership and service to working with Pacific Island student communities to gain technical skills and practical knowledge through hands-on workshops and mentorship.